

KARAN CHAWLA DORA

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EXPERIENCE

SAE AutoDrive - Toronto Autonomous Vehicle Team (aUToronto)

Sep. 2025 – Present

State Estimation Developer

Toronto, ON

- Developed a lane localization pipeline to preserve autonomous vehicle pose accuracy during GPS dropouts.
- Implemented an Iterated Extended Kalman Filter (**IEKF**) processing 100+ lane observations per 5 meters.
- Built **ROS2** bag analysis and validation workflows to evaluate performance across simulation and vehicle tests.

FIRST Robotics Competition

Jul. 2021 – Jun. 2025

Robotics Team Captain & Software Development Lead

Ottawa, ON

- Led a 90+ student robotics team to national-level competition, including **World Championship** qualification and **2x Provincial Finalist** finishes.
- Developed reliable autonomous routines in **C++** using computer vision, odometry, and path planning.
- Improved robot precision by tuning feedforward and PID feedback **control systems** for mechanism control.

RESEARCH & PUBLICATIONS

Researcher @ Autonomous Space Robotics Lab (ASRL) | Supervisor: **Tim Barfoot**

May 2026 – Present

- Implementing a mesh radio network to enable long-range communication for multi-robot fleets.

Bruce Lab — University of Ottawa | Research Assistant

Aug. 2024

- Reduced transient time by 80% and steady-state error by 40% by implementing **C++** PID controllers for platinum-nickel electrodeposition current and voltage stabilization.
- Cut calibration time by one-third by developing a **Python** interface for autonomous trial execution and data collection.
- Expanded operating voltage range by 5x by refining an **Arduino**-based potentiostat circuit and control workflow.

Canadian Robotics and Artificial Intelligence Ethics Design Lab | Robotics Research

Aug. 2024

- Accelerated project timeline by 50% by characterizing DJI Robomaster S1 behavior in a simulated robotics environment.
- Achieved 1-second target tracking by implementing **Python** computer vision and machine learning models.

PROJECTS

Reinforcement Learning Q-Learning Trainer Simulator | Python, FastAPI, NumPy, JavaScript

June 2026

- Developed a full-stack tabular Q-learning app with custom maps, real-time WebSocket training viz, hyperparameter lab, and model validation suite.
- Deployed RL training dashboard to Fly.io with session isolation and Docker; added pytest regressions for layout parsing, reachability, and evaluation checks.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, C/C++, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML, CSS

Robotics & Control: ROS, state estimation, sensor fusion, PID control, odometry, computer vision

Tools & Libraries: Git, Arduino, NumPy, pandas, Matplotlib, Next.js

AWARDS

HackTheNorth 2024 2x Award Winner: Best Use of MongoDB, Symphonic Labs

2x FRC Provincial Finalist: FIRST Robotics 2023, 2024

Harvard-MIT Math Tournament: Qualified Participant

FIRST Alumni Entrance Scholarship: Value of \$15,000

Dean's List Semi-Finalist: FIRST Robotics Competition

University of Toronto Excellence Award (UTEA): Summer research award valued at \$7,000

EDUCATION

University of Toronto

Toronto, ON

Bachelor of Applied Science — Engineering Science (cGPA: 3.95/4.0)

2025 – 2030

Research Interests: control systems, robot autonomy, state estimation